COMP 16412: Javadoc Quick Reference Sheet

The word Javadoc is typically used to refer to three things:

1. A **style of writing comments** that can be used to generate documentation for your code
2. A **tool** for turning those comments into HTML documentation
3. The resulting **HTML output** (including the HTML documentation in the same form used in the main Java APIs)

Writing Javadoc comments:

```
/**
 * Class providing some convenience operations for file management.
 * @author Sarah Clinch
 * @version 1.1, 29th March 2021
 * @see java.nio.file.Path
 */
Class MyFileManager {

    /**
     * A String representation of the path representing the
     * root directory (i.e. where files will be read
     * from/written to).
     */
    protected String directoryRoot;

    /**
     * Gets the full String path for a file with the specified
     * basename. This will usually be the basename appended to
     * this object's {@link #directoryRoot}.
     * @param basename the filename to build a full path for.
     * @return Returns a String representation of the full path.
     * @throws java.io.IOException Indicates a problem with
     * basename.
     */
    public String getPath(String basename) throws IOException {
```

description

@see and @link provide different ways of referencing other pieces of relevant documentation.

description

Document all **public/protected** classes and members.

(private members are optional)

description

parameter(s)

return value

exception(s)

name of parameter

Constructors are members too!

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Running the Javadoc tool

path to write html to

where to look for source code

```
sarah — -bash — 79×8
$ javadoc -d ./html-javadocs -sourcepath ./solution
  -subpackages maze

$ javadoc -d ./html-javadocs MyFileManager.java
```

For packages

For classes

package(s) to generate docs for

class(es) to generate docs for

Looking Javadoc output

Class MyFileManager

java.lang.Object
MyFileManager

public class **MyFileManager**
extends java.lang.Object

Class providing some convenience operations for file management.

See Also:
Path

These snippets exactly match the output for the code in the leftmost column.

directoryRoot

protected java.lang.String directoryRoot

A String representation of the path representing the root directory (i.e. where files will be read from/written to).

getPath

public java.lang.String getPath(java.lang.String basename) throws java.io.IOException

Gets the full String path for a file with the specified basename. This will usually be the basename appended to this object's directoryRoot.

Parameters:
basename - the filename to build a full path for.

Returns:
Returns a String representation of the full path.

Throws:
java.io.IOException - Indicates problem with basename.